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Enhance

Bhaskar Sarma

"One can do anything, anything at all...if provided with a passionate and gifted teacher"—Pat Conroy

The Internet is chock-full of learning resources, but all of it is disorganised, and not something you will find easily—yes, even with the power of Google at your fingertips. The problem is that there are thousands of guides, tutorials, wikis and blogs online, but can you really tell casual information or personal thoughts from educational information? If you want to learn something more formally, with paced lessons and grades, you could sign up for an online course offered by various universities.

These online courses, which have seen a big boom in recent years, are taught by professors who are often legendary in their respective fields, and you get access to lectures that are usually delivered to packed auditoriums. Anything from Engineering, Liberal Arts, Science, Management

and Health is available, and at various levels—from a certificate grade to Masters. Obviously, these are paid services.

However, recently we've seen big names in education offering their course material for free online. This means that *anyone*—students, educators, housewives or grandfathers—can sign-up for them. There is no educational requirement and no schedule—you can learn at your own pace and at your convenience. The only pre-requisites are the willingness to learn and access to the Internet. In this article, we will look at a few top-notch universities and institutions that are offering such courses.

MIT OpenCourseWare

(<http://ocw.mit.edu>)

Do we really need to introduce Massachusetts Institute of Technology? For quite a while now, MIT has put up select courses online. All of them are actual courses that were taught in classrooms in MIT, and you can effectively get the same high quality education that students pay premium for.

Want a college education, but don't care about grades or have no cash to spare? Get online and get educated



Ashwini Bavisar

Educ@tion